Zerodha Coin SIP case: Part 6 MVP tester feedback

Four testers (P1 to P4) tried My SIP Buddy and sent their feedback on WhatsApp, in Hinglish and Hindi; it is translated here. Eight further voice notes from testers were transcribed on the case author's own machine (the audio never left it). This document lists what they said and what changed in the MVP because of it.

What testers said overall

- **3 of 4 wanted fund suggestions or a fund list** (P1, P2, P4), and still did after the first changes.
- **3 of 4 couldn't tell who it was for or why they'd use it** instead of other tools (P1, P2, P3).
- **2 found it cluttered** (P2, P3): too much text, and charts that didn't explain themselves.
- **P4 wanted more coverage:** expense ratios, switching plans and tax options beyond ELSS.
- **P2 tested hardest:** typed unrealistic targets ("44% a year"), asked what the numbers were based on, and wanted to be asked first whether they were a first-time or regular investor.
- **The voice notes asked for depth on tax and debt funds:** old vs new tax sections, STT, IEPF, debt funds and an equity-vs-debt comparison.

Feedback and what changed

Tester said	Who	What changed in the MVP
Wants fund suggestions or a fund list	P1, P2, P4	A "How do fund types compare?" view: large, mid and small cap side by side with their index's 1-year and 5-year returns and an ups-and-downs scale. Flexi cap, ELSS, index and liquid funds explained. Still no fund names.
Unclear who it is for, or why use it over other tools	P1, P2, P3	New start page: who it is for, what you can ask, all disclaimers in one place, and "picture this inside Coin's SIP screen" so there is no app switch.

Tester said	Who	What changed in the MVP
Cluttered, too much text, charts not self-explanatory	P2, P3	Plain chat layout, replies cut to 60 words, one picture per answer with a plain headline, extra charts behind "See how it would grow".
"Without AI" tab shows too much at once	P3	Now a list of five tools, each opening on its own.
Answers lean on "SEBI registration"; same checklist every time	P4	Fund replies say once that it doesn't pick funds, then show the comparison. The adviser line stays only for stop, switch or wait questions.
"Expense ratio" sent to support; add an expense ratio to the calculator	P4	A new route to explain terms, and a fee calculator showing the rupee cost of a higher expense ratio. The goal check takes an optional expense ratio.
Doesn't cover switching plans	P4	Switching guide: on Coin you sell and then buy, so check exit load and tax first. "Should I switch?" is still declined, with the guide shown.
Tax saving only mentions ELSS	P4	Tax options added: old vs new regime, Section 80C options and the NPS extra deduction.
First-timers type unrealistic targets, such as 44% a year	P2	"44% a year" is read as a target and compared with market history.
The "double" starter opened with a long, robotic paragraph	P2	The starter now asks "Will ₹3,000 a month double in 2 years?", so the first answer is the comparison itself.
The name	P4	Renamed from "Your SIP Companion" to "My SIP Buddy".
Buttons answered a made-up example instead of asking for my details	P2	Each button now asks first and says why: goal (amount, target, years, fund type), failed instalment (six reasons to pick from), flat SIP (fund type, then the numbers).

Tester said	Who	What changed in the MVP
On what basis are these numbers?	P2	Answers use NSE's total return history from 2005 and live index levels, show how past SIPs of the same length ended, and are labelled "Past results, not a forecast", with sources.
Ask up front whether I'm a first-time or regular investor	P2	After Start, one question asks "How far into your SIP?". It changes only the greeting and the order of questions; nothing about it reaches the AI.
Why use this here and not elsewhere?	P1, P2	A "Why use it" box: built for the moments people stop, about your SIP rather than fund rankings, and inside Coin.
"Without AI" gives the same as the AI	P2	Hidden from testers. The chat still falls back to pre-written replies when the AI is busy.
A riskometer means nothing without a fund	P2	The checks ask the fund type first, and the riskometer note says to read it on a specific fund's page.
Still wants fund names	P1, P2, P4	"Why no fund names?" added: naming or ranking funds is investment advice, which needs SEBI registration; inside Coin, each fund's own page is one tap away.
The first chat answered "flexi cap vs small cap for the short term" with generic text, different each time	Tester	Rebuilt as an AI agent that picks the right tool, keeps the conversation and compares fund types with real index data.
Tax view hidden; no debt funds; old vs new tax sections; STT and IEPF missing; equity vs debt comparison wanted; switching is a sale for tax	Voice notes (8)	A "Tax on SIPs and saving tax" question; debt and liquid fund cards with debt index returns; an equity-vs-debt table; an IEPF entry; the switching card says a switch is a sale and is taxed.

What we did not change, and why

- **Naming, ranking or suggesting funds** (P1, P2, P4): that is investment advice, which needs SEBI registration, so it stays out. The fund-type comparison is the compliant middle ground.
- **"Pause or move" suggestions like other apps make** (P1, P2, P4): also advice, so not added.
- **Portfolio reviews for experienced investors** (P2): outside the first-year segment the MVP is built for.
- **Comparing real funds side by side** (P1): needs fund data that would come from Coin itself.